

Word family: **drill / drills / drilled / drilling / driller**

Base word: drill

Forms: drills, drilled, drilling

Related form: driller

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “...they are increasingly being used for lengthy activities such as tutorial lessons, mock interviews and worksheet **drilling**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **drilling** means **repeated, intensive practice of the same type of exercise in order to improve accuracy, speed, memory, or automatic performance**.

In an educational context, **worksheet drilling** means repeatedly completing similar worksheet exercises.

繁體中文： **反覆操練；密集練習；透過重複做相似題目來熟習知識或技能**

中文翻譯：

> “...tutorial lessons, mock interviews and worksheet **drilling**.”

「.....補習課、模擬面試，以及大量重複的工作紙**操練 / 刷題練習**。」

Here:

worksheet drilling = 反覆完成大量類似工作紙題目，以熟習題型、答案或技巧

1. **drill = repeated practice/training (操練) — 反覆練習；訓練**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Repeated practice intended to make a skill, response, fact, or procedure automatic and accurate.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Some students spend hours doing worksheet **drills**.”

「有些學生花數小時做工作紙**操練**。」

Practice 2

> “The teacher used vocabulary ****drills**** to help students remember the words.”

「老師用詞彙****反覆操練****幫助學生記住單字。」

Practice 3

> “The team practised passing ****drills****.”

「球隊進行傳球****訓練****。」

****drill = 為了熟練、記憶或建立自動反應而重複進行同類練習****

Common:

- * grammar drill
- * pronunciation drill
- * vocabulary drill
- * training drill
- * basketball drill

2. ****drill = verb: train through repetition (反覆訓練) — 操練 ; 反覆灌輸****

As a verb, ****drill**** means to make someone repeatedly practise something.

Practice 4

> “The teacher ****drilled**** the students on multiplication tables.”

「老師反覆****操練****學生的乘數表。」

Practice 5

> “The coach ****drilled**** the players in defensive techniques.”

「教練反覆****訓練****球員的防守技巧。」

****drill someone in/on something = 讓某人反覆練習某項知識、程序或技巧****

This is the verb counterpart of Meaning 1.

3. **drill = repeatedly teach until firmly remembered (灌輸) — 反覆教導；灌輸**

The verb can emphasize information being impressed into someone's memory.

Practice 6

> “The rules were **drilled into** us from the first day.”

「那些規則從第一天起就被反覆**灌輸給我們**。」

Practice 7

> “Safety procedures were **drilled into** every employee.”

「安全程序被反覆**灌輸**給每名員工。」

drill something into someone = 透過反覆提醒或練習，使某件事牢牢記住

This is closely related to Meaning 2, but the figurative “implant firmly in memory” nuance is worth teaching.

4. **drill = organized practice for an emergency/procedure (演習) — 演習；訓練**

A **drill** can be a planned practice of what people should do in an emergency or specific situation.

Practice 8

> “The school held a fire **drill**.”

「學校舉行了一次消防**演習**。」

Practice 9

> “Everyone must participate in the evacuation **drill**.”

「所有人都必須參加疏散**演習**。」

drill = 為了熟習緊急程序或正式流程而進行的模擬演習

Common:

* fire drill

- * evacuation drill
- * emergency drill
- * safety drill
- * disaster drill

For strict counting, this is still part of the broader ****practice/training**** concept, but it is an extremely important subtype.

5. ****drill = military training in coordinated movements (軍事) — 操練 ; 隊列訓練****

Historically and still today, ****drill**** is strongly associated with military training.

Practice 10

> “The soldiers practised military ****drill**** every morning.”

「士兵每天早上進行軍事****操練****。」

Practice 11

> “The recruits were taught basic ****drill****.”

「新兵接受基本的****隊列操練****。」

****military drill = 反覆訓練士兵按指令整齊、準確地完成動作或程序****

This is one of the roots of the modern educational/training meaning.

6. ****drill = tool/machine for making holes (工具) — 鑽 ; 電鑽 ; 鑽孔機****

A completely different major noun sense.

****Meaning:**** A tool or machine used to make holes in hard material.

Practice 12

> “He used a ****drill**** to make a hole in the wall.”

「他用****電鑽****在牆上鑽了一個洞。」

Practice 13

> “The dentist picked up the **drill**.”

「牙醫拿起了**牙鑽**。」

drill = 用旋轉鑽頭在木材、金屬、牆壁、牙齒等鑽孔的工具 / 機器

Common:

- * electric drill
- * power drill
- * dental drill
- * hand drill

This is a genuinely distinct core meaning.

7. **drill = verb: make a hole using a drill (鑽孔) — 鑽 ; 鑽孔**

Practice 14

> “They **drilled** a hole through the wall.”

「他們在牆上**鑽了一個洞**。」

Practice 15

> “The dentist had to **drill** the tooth.”

「牙醫需要**鑽磨**那顆牙齒。」

drill = 使用鑽頭旋轉切削，在某物上形成孔洞

Common:

- * drill a hole
- * drill into concrete
- * drill through metal
- * drill a tooth

8. **drill = bore into the ground for oil, gas, water, etc. (鑽探) — 鑽井 ; 鑽探**

Drill is very common in geology, mining, energy, and construction.

Practice 16

> “The company began ****drilling**** for oil.”

「公司開始****鑽探石油****。」

Practice 17

> “They ****drilled**** deep underground for water.”

「他們向地下深處****鑽井取水****。」

****drill for something** = 向地下鑽探以尋找或取得石油、天然氣、水或礦物等******

This belongs conceptually to physical drilling but is important enough to surface explicitly.

9. ****drill** = make a deep hole/well (鑽孔 / 鑽井) — 鑽孔 ; 鑽井******

As a noun in industrial contexts, ****drilling**** can refer to the entire operation:

- > offshore drilling
- > exploratory drilling
- > oil drilling

Practice 18

> “Offshore ****drilling**** began in the region.”

「該區開始進行海上****鑽探****。」

For strict counting, this remains under the physical-hole branch.

10. ****drill** = question someone persistently and intensely (盤問) — 追問 ; 盤問******

****Drill**** can figuratively mean asking someone many detailed questions, often repeatedly.

Practice 19

> “The interviewer ****drilled**** him about his previous experience.”

「面試官就他之前的經驗不停****追問****。」

Practice 20

> “She was ****drilled**** on every detail of the proposal.”

「她被人就提案的每個細節反覆****盤問****。」

****drill someone about/on something = 對某人作密集、反覆而詳細的提問****

This develops from the image of persistent, penetrating pressure.

It is less central than ****question/interrogate****, but established.

11. ****drill into = penetrate deeply (鑽入) — 鑽進 ; 深入穿透****

Literally:

> “The bit drilled into the rock.”

「鑽頭****鑽進****岩石。」

Figuratively, it can overlap with:

> drill information into someone

But because ****drill into**** can be phrasal/constructional, I would not make it a separate base meaning.

12. ****drill down = examine increasingly detailed information (商業 / 科技片語) — 深入分析 ; 逐層查看****

A common modern phrasal use, especially in:

- * data analysis
- * business
- * computing
- * dashboards

Practice 21

> “You can ****drill down**** into the data by region.”

「你可以按地區進一步****深入查看 / 逐層分析****數據。」

****drill down = 從較概括的資料逐步深入到更詳細的層級****

This is useful, but under our SOP I would keep it as a phrasal extension rather than a bare ****drill**** sense.

13. ****drill = sow seeds in rows / seed-drilling (農業) — 條播；用播種機播種****

This is an established agricultural sense.

Practice 22

> “The seeds were ****drilled**** directly into the soil.”

「種子以****條播方式****直接播入土壤。」

Practice 23

> “Farmers ****drill**** wheat in autumn.”

「農民在秋天以****條播方式種植****小麥。」

****drill seed/grain = 把種子以整齊行列播入土壤，通常使用播種機****

This is a genuine distinct specialist verb sense.

14. ****drill = row/furrow in which seeds are planted (農業名詞) — 播種溝；條播行****

In agricultural terminology, ****drill**** can also mean the row or furrow into which seed is placed.

Example:

> “The seeds were planted in drills.”

「種子被播在一行行的****播種溝****中。」

This is specialist and lower priority for general learners.

15. ****seed drill = agricultural sowing machine (農業) — 條播機；播種機****

A **seed drill** is a machine that plants seeds at controlled depth and spacing in rows.

This is lexicalized enough that I would store it as a compound rather than another bare-word meaning.

16. **drill** = strong twilled fabric (布料) — 斜紋厚布 ; 卡其斜紋布

This is another genuine noun sense often missed in general learner entries.

Drill is a strong, durable cotton or similar fabric with a diagonal weave, historically used for uniforms and workwear.

Practice 24

> “The trousers were made of cotton **drill**.”

「這條褲子用厚實的棉質**斜紋布**製成。」

drill = 一種結實耐用、具有斜紋織法的布料

Common:

* cotton drill

* khaki drill

This is legitimate but lower-frequency today.

17. **drill** = genre of rap music (音樂) — Drill 音樂 ; 鑽頭音樂類型

In modern music, **drill** is a genre/subgenre of rap associated originally with Chicago and later strongly with UK drill and other regional scenes.

Practice 25

> “He listens to UK **drill**.”

「他會聽英國的 **drill 音樂**。」

Practice 26

> “The artist became known in the **drill** scene.”

「那位藝人在 **drill 音樂圈**中開始受到注意。」

This is a genuine modern lexical sense.

Because it is culturally specific but no longer obscure, I would retain it as a lower-priority modern domain meaning.

18. **drill = a species of primate (動物) — 山魈近親 Drill 猴**

A **drill** is also a large African primate, *Mandrillus leucophaeus*, closely related to the mandrill.

Example:

> “The zoo participates in a conservation programme for drills.”

「這間動物園參與 drill 猴的保育計劃。」

This is a genuine zoological sense but clearly specialist.

Database status: recognize, low priority.

Related form: **driller**

A **driller** can mean a person who operates drilling equipment, especially in mining/oil exploration.

Practice 27

> “The **drillers** worked through the night.”

「鑽探**工人**徹夜工作。」

driller = 操作鑽探設備的人

Related form: **drilling**

Besides the -ing verb form, **drilling** can function as a noun:

Training

- > pronunciation drilling
- > worksheet drilling

= ****操練****

Industrial

- > oil drilling
- > offshore drilling

= ****鑽探****

Same form, radically different branch.

Important distinction: ****drill vs practice****

****practice****

is the broad term for repeated activity to improve ability.

****drill****

usually emphasizes:

- * repetition
- * structure
- * automatic response
- * accuracy
- * often doing the same type repeatedly

- > speaking practice
- > grammar drills

So ****drill**** usually sounds more repetitive and controlled.

Important distinction: ****drill vs exercise****

****exercise****

= one task/activity used for learning or training

****drill****

= repeated systematic practice, often involving many similar exercises

> grammar exercise

> grammar drill

A drill can consist of many repeated exercises.

Important distinction: ****drill vs rehearse****

****rehearse****

means practise a complete performance, speech, play, procedure, etc. before doing it for real.

****drill****

usually focuses more narrowly on repeated actions or responses.

> rehearse a presentation

> drill emergency procedures

Important distinction: ****drill vs train****

****train****

is the broad process of developing skills or fitness.

****drill****

is one intensive repetitive training method.

> train a team

> drill the team on defensive movements

Important distinction: ****drill vs bore****

For making holes:

****drill****

typically means make a hole using rotating cutting equipment.

bore

also means create/enlarge a hole, often emphasizing the hole-making process itself and used in technical contexts.

- > drill a hole
- > bore a tunnel

They overlap in engineering.

Important distinction: **drill vs dig**

dig

means remove soil/material to create a hole/trench.

drill

means penetrate material with a rotating tool or drilling equipment.

- > dig a trench
- > drill a well

Grammar note: **drill someone in/on something**

Both occur:

- > drill students **in** grammar
- > drill students **on** vocabulary

In often emphasizes the skill/subject being taught.

On often emphasizes the material being tested/practised.

Grammar note: **drill for**

In extraction:

- > drill for oil
- > drill for gas
- > drill for water

This does ****not**** mean practise for oil; the domain determines the physical drilling sense.

Countability note

****Drill**** is countable in many noun senses:

- > a drill
- > several drills

Examples:

- * a fire drill
- * a grammar drill
- * a power drill

But some domain nouns can be uncountable:

- > military drill
- > cotton drill
- > drill music

So countability changes substantially by sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****drill****
- * ****drills****
- * ****drilled****
- * ****drilling****
- * ****driller****

Useful compounds/constructions include:

- * worksheet drill
- * pronunciation drill
- * fire drill

- * emergency drill
- * power drill
- * dental drill
- * drill for oil
- * seed drill
- * drill down
- * cotton drill
- * drill music

The main semantic branches are much broader than they initially appear, so this is exactly the sort of word that benefits from the full second-pass sweep before merging.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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drill — repeated practice	透過重複同類活動，使知識、技巧或反應變得熟練 / 自動化的操練
drill — verb, train	反覆訓練某人某項知識、程序或技巧
drill something into someone	透過反覆提醒 / 操練，把知識或規則牢牢灌輸給某人
drill — emergency practice	為熟習消防、疏散等程序而進行的模擬演習
drill — military	軍事隊列和程序的反覆操練
drill — tool	用旋轉鑽頭鑽孔的工具 / 機器
drill — verb, hole	用鑽具在木材、金屬、牆壁、牙齒等鑽孔
drill — extraction	向地下鑽探以尋找 / 取得石油、天然氣、水等
drill — question intensely	對某人反覆、詳細地追問 / 盤問
drill — agriculture	以整齊行列把種子播進土壤；條播
drill — agricultural row	播種溝 / 條播行；專門
drill — fabric	結實耐用的斜紋布；如 cotton drill
drill — music	現代 rap 的 drill 音樂類型
drill — primate	一種非洲靈長類動物；專門
driller	操作鑽井 / 鑽探設備的人

For your original sentence

> “...tutorial lessons, mock interviews and worksheet ****drilling****.”

The exact meaning is:

****drilling = 讓學生反覆完成相似題目 / 工作紙，使答案、知識或答題技巧變得熟練****

So:

> ****worksheet drilling****

= ****工作紙反覆操練 / 大量刷類似題目****

The phrase carries a slightly mechanical flavor: students are repeatedly practising material rather than necessarily engaging in open-ended exploration.

For your database, I would count **7** genuinely useful modern core meanings for `drill`:

1. **repetitive training/practice**
2. **organized emergency/military rehearsal** — closely related to #1 but useful enough to surface
3. **tool for making holes**
4. **verb — bore/make holes or drill underground**
5. **question someone intensely**
6. **agricultural sowing in rows**
7. **modern music genre**

I would keep **cotton drill** as a lower-priority but genuine material sense, keep the primate as specialist zoological vocabulary, and treat **drill down** as a phrasal extension rather than inflate the core count.